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Flip Deal Checklist

Run every fix-and-flip through the same list before you make an offer.

Use one copy per property. Check each box only when you have verified the item yourself or with a qualified professional. Write your numbers in the margins.

1. Before you fall in love with the house

- [ ] Target area and buyer profile are defined (who buys the finished home, and at what price range).
- [ ] Flood zone checked for the exact address.
- [ ] HOA or deed restrictions checked (rental limits, exterior rules, flip or resale rules).
- [ ] Open permits, expired permits, and code violations checked with the county or city.
- [ ] Title search ordered, and liens or judgments reviewed.
- [ ] Homeowners and flood insurance quotes requested (roof age and wind mitigation can change the price a lot).

2. Build your ARV (after-repair value)

- [ ] Pull 3 to 5 recent SOLD homes, not just active listings, that are close by and similar in size, style, and finished condition.
- [ ] Adjust each comp for bedrooms, baths, square footage, lot, garage, pool, and condition.
- [ ] Note how long each comp took to sell, not just what it sold for.
- [ ] Write down three ARV numbers: conservative, expected, and best case. Plan your offer around the conservative one.
- [ ] Ask a local agent to sanity-check your comps. Different eyes catch bad assumptions.

3. Repair walk-through

- [ ] Roof: age, leaks, soft spots, decking, previous repairs.
- [ ] HVAC: age, type, and whether it runs and cools properly.
- [ ] Plumbing: supply and drain materials, active leaks, water heater age.
- [ ] Electrical: panel type and condition, visible wiring problems, grounding.
- [ ] Foundation and structure: cracks, settling, sagging floors, wood damage, signs of termites.
- [ ] Moisture and mold: stains, odors, past water intrusion, drainage around the house.
- [ ] Windows, doors, and exterior: condition, openings, siding, fascia, fence, pool if any.
- [ ] Kitchen, baths, flooring, paint: decide the finish level that matches your buyer.
- [ ] Mark every item that needs a licensed contractor or a permit.

- [ ] Get written bids for big items. Add a contingency line for surprises.

4. Know your numbers

- [ ] Purchase price and your buying closing costs.
- [ ] Repair budget plus contingency.
- [ ] Holding costs for each month: taxes, insurance, utilities, loan interest, HOA.
- [ ] Financing costs: points, fees, draws, inspection fees.
- [ ] Selling costs: commission, closing costs, concessions you may offer.
- [ ] Profit = ARV minus every cost above. Set your walk-away number BEFORE you negotiate.

5. Schedule and exit plan

- [ ] Realistic timeline written out: permits, contractor availability, inspections, and time on market.
- [ ] Primary exit chosen: sell the finished home, sell to another investor, or rent and refinance.
- [ ] Backup exit chosen in case the market or your timeline changes.

6. Red flags to slow down for

- [ ] Unpermitted additions or work you cannot verify.
- [ ] Seller will not allow inspections or a reasonable due diligence period.
- [ ] Title, lien, or ownership questions that are not clear.
- [ ] Comps are thin, old, or all much nicer than what you will produce.
- [ ] Insurance is hard to get, or flood or wind costs change the math.
- [ ] Repair scope keeps growing every time you walk the property.

Next step: Have an address you are thinking about? Send it to Tony and he can help you pull and review comps.
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